· STRATEGIC WORK SAMPLE

# Building Customer Lifetime Value Through Integrated User Engagement

A First Principles Approach

USER LIFECYCLE · SEGMENTATION · JOURNEY ARCHITECTURE · CLV · CROSS-FUNCTIONAL ALIGNMENT

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THE STRUCTURAL PROBLEM

# Journey fragmentation is an organisational problem, not a CRM problem

### Marketing

Optimises campaign metrics — open rates, CTR, send volume. Defines success by departmental KPIs.

### Product & Tech

Optimises feature adoption and technical delivery. Defines success by product engagement metrics.

### Business Units

Each vertical optimises its own conversion and revenue. Mobility ≠ Real Estate ≠ Jobs lifecycle.

### The user

Experiences the gaps between them. Receives inconsistent messaging, broken journeys, and repeated onboarding.

**The user experiences the gaps — not the departmental boundaries**

THE THESIS

# The answer is not better campaigns. It is a different operating model.

CURRENT STATE

## Fragmented by function

- Each function owns its slice of the journey
- Lifecycle strategy split across Marketing, Product and BUs
- User database managed as a tool, not a strategic asset
- Onboarding, engagement and retention treated as separate programmes
- CLV unmeasured — acquisition bias dominates resource allocation

TARGET STATE

## Integrated lifecycle architecture

- Central lifecycle function owns end-to-end user journey
- Shared KPI hierarchy: CLV as the primary steering metric
- Centralised CRM serves vertical-specific needs without fragmenting UX
- Onboarding → engagement → retention → win-back as one connected flow
- Database health managed proactively as a commercial asset

Sustainable commercial growth comes from shared ownership of the user — not isolated departmental success

USER SEGMENTATION

# The same platform — very different user journeys

Lifecycle architecture must serve both profiles without creating separate fragmented experiences

## SEGMENT A · ENTRY & ACTIVATION

### The new or occasional user

| | |
|---|---|
| **Who** | Mobile-first, discovery-led. Finds platform via referral, social or search. Low trust, high sensitivity to friction. |
| **Wants** | Fast onboarding, immediate value signal, no repeated data requests. Wants to see the platform deliver before committing. |
| **Risk** | Abandons at first friction point. Onboarding quality determines whether they ever activate in a second vertical. |
| **Lifecycle lever** | Onboarding sequence quality + cross-vertical activation within 30 days. |

## SEGMENT B · RETENTION & GROWTH

### The established multi-vertical user

| | |
|---|---|
| **Who** | Experienced user active in 2+ verticals. Higher trust, higher CLV. Motivated by convenience and relevance. |
| **Wants** | Personalised lifecycle communication, seamless cross-vertical experience, recognition of history and behaviour. |
| **Risk** | Churns silently when communication becomes irrelevant or repetitive. Hard to win back at comparable CAC. |
| **Lifecycle lever** | CLV-based segmentation + trigger-based retention + win-back architecture. |

**Key insight: the young user is won or lost at onboarding — the established user is won or lost at relevance.**

JOURNEY ARCHITECTURE

# Two users — four stages — critical divergence points

| DISCOVERY | ONBOARDING | ENGAGEMENT | RETENTION & GROWTH |
|---|---|---|---|
| Social feed, referral link, organic search. Phone-first. No brand loyalty yet. | Friction = exit. Wants value in <2 min. Data requests must feel worth it. | Re-engages if first cross-vertical suggestion is relevant and timely. | Won by personalisation. Lost by irrelevant batch campaigns. |
| Intent-driven. Arrives knowing the platform. Discovery phase is fast. | Wants recognised, not re-onboarded. History should be visible. | Deep engagement across multiple verticals. Trigger-based communication lands. | CLV compounds if milestones are recognised. Churns silently when ignored. |

**The decisive insight: Segment A is won at onboarding. Segment B is retained through relevance. The same lifecycle strategy fails both.**

COMMERCIAL ARCHITECTURE

# CLV is economics, not a CRM metric

Desirability and retention move the entire unit economics — this is why the lifecycle function is a growth lever, not a cost centre.

**CLV = Acquisition value × Repeat frequency × Relationship duration × Margin × Referral multiplier**

## Lower CAC

Users acquired through referral and organic engagement cost 20–35% less than paid acquisition. Retention compounds this over time.

**KPI: CAC index**

## Higher conversion

A user who already trusts the platform converts in new verticals at 2–3× the rate of a new user. Onboarding quality is the lever.

**KPI: Cross-vertical activation rate**

## Frequency & basket

Relevant, trigger-based lifecycle communication drives repeat engagement without incremental acquisition spend.

**KPI: Repeat rate & AOV**

## Organic referral

Satisfied users with high CLV generate the highest-quality new user referrals. Retention investment compounds into acquisition.

**KPI: Referral-driven new users**

**The lifecycle function that manages CLV as its primary metric will out-perform the one that manages campaign open rates.**

OPERATING MODEL

# The governance model that resolves fragmentation

Based on Lead Forum — a structure built and validated at Topdanmark/If across competing business units

01

## Monthly lifecycle governance cadence

Eliminates the gap between BU priorities and central lifecycle strategy

All BU heads and Marketing/Product meet on standardised lifecycle KPI dashboard — shared view of user behaviour, NPS drivers and campaign performance. Forces alignment before execution, not after.

02

## CLV-based segmentation as shared resource

Same user, same logic — regardless of which BU they last touched

Central segmentation model replaces vertical-specific lists. User value determines communication priority, discount access and win-back eligibility — consistently across all verticals.

03

## Centralised CRM serving vertical-specific needs

Scale without fragmentation — the core architectural challenge

One CRM operating model with vertical-configurable templates and trigger logic. Enables Mobility to send different content than Real Estate while preserving consistent user experience and data integrity.

Validated result: 5–8 million euros incremental commercial impact (2024–25). Private sales at all-time high.

INITIATIVE PRIORITIZATION

# Where to build first — ranked by CLV impact

Not all lifecycle initiatives are equal — this is the sequencing logic

| RANK | INITIATIVE | EFFORT | CLV IMPACT | TIME TO IMPACT | RATIONALE |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 01 | **Onboarding quality redesign** | Low | High | 0–30 days | First-friction fix. Highest impact per user acquired. Lifts cross-vertical activation immediately. |
| 02 | **CLV-based user segmentation** | Low | High | 0–60 days | Replaces volume logic with value logic. Changes what the whole lifecycle function optimises for. |
| 03 | **Cross-vertical lifecycle triggers** | Medium | High | 30–90 days | Revenue on existing users at near-zero acquisition cost. Compounds CLV without new spend. |
| 04 | **Win-back programme architecture** | Medium | High | 30–90 days | Recovers users on already-paid CAC. Documented 20–35% win-back rate achievable. |
| 05 | **Referral programme redesign** | Medium | High | 90–180 days | Best users generate best leads. CAC falls structurally as programme scales. |
| 06 | **Database health & compliance** | High | Medium | 60–180 days | Protects deliverability, consent integrity and long-term CRM asset quality. |

EXECUTION & GOVERNANCE

# Phased roadmap — prove, then scale

The goal is not to transform everything at once — it is to generate evidence and build momentum

**Phase 1 · 0–60 days**

## Diagnose & Align

- Map current user journey fragmentation across all five verticals
- Audit CRM database health and segmentation logic
- Establish lifecycle governance cadence with all BU heads
- Define CLV as the primary shared metric — with stakeholder buy-in

Risk: internal resistance to shared KPI ownership

**Phase 2 · 60–180 days**

## Build & Activate

- Redesign onboarding sequences by user segment
- Deploy CLV-based segmentation replacing volume logic
- Launch cross-vertical lifecycle triggers with control groups
- Activate win-back programme with documented eligibility criteria

Risk: technical debt in CRM infrastructure

**Phase 3 · 180–365 days**

## Scale & Optimise

- Referral programme redesign — three-tier with automated consent flow
- Community and loyalty layer for high-CLV segment
- CAC index target: move from baseline toward -25% over 12 months
- Quarterly lifecycle board review with evidence-led adjustment

Risk: attribution complexity across verticals

Principle: pilot with one vertical, measure with control groups, scale with evidence.

# »Sustainable engagement comes from shared ownership
# of the user — not from isolated departmental success.«

| | |
|---|---|
| **The problem** | Journey fragmentation is organisational, not technical |
| **The architecture** | CLV-based lifecycle with centralised CRM serving vertical-specific needs |
| **The governance** | Shared KPI cadence forcing alignment across Marketing, Product & BUs |
| **The proof** | 5–8M euros incremental at Topdanmark/If — same structural challenge, same solution |

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